instruments can target two levels of actors: member states and their domestic publics. Our theory highlights four main methods that IOs use to defend themselves, which span both of these levels: sidelining or appeasing unfriendly leaders and sidelining or appeasing their constituents. IOs sideline populist leaders by relying on them less heavily for things they need, like funding and information. Or, IOs marginalize or obscure activities from populists' constituents so that populists can avoid domestic penalties associated with cooperation. IOs also appease populists by providing them with greater benefits and reduced costs or mollify constituents by appealing directly to them.

This framework enables us to analyze how IOs evolve systematically and to generate testable predictions. In the empirical chapters, we leverage new data to rigorously evaluate each of these mechanisms, providing evidence to support our theoretical claim that IOs can maintain resilience in the face of external threats. Our findings demonstrate that populist challenges compel IOs to confront status quo biases and adopt meaningful reforms.

However, while populist hostility drives IOs to defend themselves in order to remain viable, these methods have unintended consequences. While some tactics can make IOs more responsive to the public and efficacious, others can have pernicious effects. For instance, IOs' forays into secrecy and bribery can make them less legitimate, less transparent, and overextended, thereby threatening the normative pillars of global governance. Indeed, in their struggle to combat populism, IOs may inadvertently sow the seeds of further populist backlash, undermining the very legitimacy they seek to protect. Throughout this book, we discuss how IOs can avoid such negative outcomes, remaining vibrant despite ongoing populist resistance.

1.2 Why Populism?

Scholars and policymakers frequently bemoan the many barriers confronting international institutions (Gray 2018; von Borzyskowski and Vabulas 2019b; Lake, Martin, and Risse 2021; Dellmuth and Tallberg 2023) and the liberal international order more broadly (Borzel and Zürn 2021; Farrell and Newman 2021; Weiss and Wallace 2021). Indeed, a plethora of hostile actors actively work against international cooperation. A variety of factors cause negative perceptions of IOs, including perverse economic experiences